

Sam Bai

Full-Stack Software Engineer

Hamilton, NZ | Permanent Resident

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Professional Summary

Full-stack developer building production SaaS with Next.js 16, TypeScript, and modern backends. Created a job tracking system (actively using it for this search), a task management platform with real-time collaboration, and developed features for a community transport platform during a 4-month internship. 2024 graduate with end-to-end delivery experience from database design through deployment

Technical Skills

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Python, C#, SQL, HTML5, CSS3

Frontend: React.js, Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Shadcn, Framer Motion, GSAP, dnd-kit

Backend: Node.js, MongoDB Atlas, Supabase (PostgreSQL + RLS), Upstash Redis, SWR, Zod, Clerk, Better-Auth, Cheerio

Tools & Platforms: Git/GitHub, VS Code, Vercel, Docker, Selenium

Testing Tools: Playwright, Vitest

Methodologies: Agile/Scrum, REST APIs, Responsive Design, Database Design

Key Projects

Job Application Tracker | Full-Stack Developer | [Live Demo](#) | [Source Code](#)

Tech Stack: Next.js 16, TypeScript, MongoDB Atlas, SWR, Zod, Better-Auth, Cheerio, GSAP, Upstash Redis, dnd-kit

- Built a production job tracking SaaS to solve my own problem during job search, now actively using it to manage applications across 4 hiring stages. Designed a Kanban interface with MongoDB transactions ensuring atomic drag-and-drop operations.
- Implemented hybrid caching architecture (React Server Components + SWR) for instant UI hydration with zero layout shift, reducing page load times by ~60%
- Developed a job parsing engine using Cheerio to pull titles, companies, locations, and seniority signals from public job listings, plus Google Calendar OAuth for automated interview scheduling
- Integrated Upstash Redis rate limiting and better-auth OAuth, showcasing flexibility beyond managed services like Clerk
- Developed an animated landing page featuring GSAP ScrollTrigger horizontal scroll effects, infinite logo carousel, and bento grid layouts

Task Management Platform | Full-Stack Developer | [Live Demo](#) | [Source Code](#)

Tech Stack: Next.js 16, Supabase (PostgreSQL + Realtime), Clerk, Stripe, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Shadcn, dnd-kit

- Engineered a production-ready task management SaaS with Stripe subscription billing, evolving from MVP to feature-complete product with 100+ commits and continuous iteration
- Implemented drag-and-drop with optimistic UI using dnd-kit, ensuring fluid interactions and instant visual feedback before server confirmation
- Designed Supabase Row Level Security (RLS) policies for secure multi-tenant data isolation, preventing cross-tenant data leakage
- Integrated real-time collaboration via Supabase Realtime subscriptions, enabling live updates across multiple users and devices

Professional Experience

Career Break & Independent Study

New Zealand & Overseas | Aug 2024 – Dec 2025

- Post-graduation period focused on family commitments, overseas travel, and building production projects (Job Tracker, TaskFlow) to advance full-stack expertise

Software Engineering Intern | Waka Transportation Community

Tech Stack: *MongoDB, Express.js, React, Node.js, Netlify, Railway, Nodemailer*

Tauranga, New Zealand | March 2024 – July 2024

- Developed and prototyped core features for the community transport platform, including user authentication and a real-time driver scheduling calendar, contributing to development of local transport services in the Eastern Bay of Plenty
- Built full-stack features across the MERN stack, taking work from requirements gathering through to testing and demonstration
- Built responsive, reusable React components from UI/UX designs, ensuring cross-browser compatibility
- Implemented REST API endpoints and integrated frontend/backend with request validation and error handling
- Debugged application issues and improved component performance using React profiling tools to reduce unnecessary re-renders
- Worked with non-technical stakeholders in weekly check-ins to confirm scope, clarify requirements, and translate feedback into deliverable tasks

Medication Tracking App (Capstone) | Project Lead & Android Developer

Tech Stack: *Kotlin, Android Studio, GitHub*

Hamilton Waikato, New Zealand | Late 2023

- Led a 4-person team to build an Android medication tracking app for Anglesea Clinic as part of a Kotlin mobile development course, acting as project manager and coordinating implementation work.
- Managed requirements and feedback with clinical staff, made key UI/UX and implementation decisions, and kept the codebase consistent through informal reviews.
- Coordinated development of core features such as medication schedules, reminders, and drug management screens, and presented the final app to clinicians for validation.

Education

Bachelor of Applied Information Technology (Software Engineering)

Waikato Institute of Technology (Wintec) | Hamilton, New Zealand

Graduated: Class of 2024

Relevant Coursework: *Software Development, Web Development, Database Design & SQL, Systems Analysis, OOP, Software Testing, Mobile Apps, Cyber Security, Big Data & Analytics, Game Development, Project Management / SE Project*

Additional Information

Work Eligibility:

NZ Permanent Resident (Full Work Rights); based in Hamilton and open to in-office, hybrid, or remote roles nationwide